

ST OSWALD'S TEACHING HOSPITAL

Medicines Information Service

FORMULARY NOTE: PENICILLIN BRAND EQUIVALENCE

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Author: Ms Priya Raghunathan, Lead Antimicrobial Pharmacist

1. PURPOSE

Several penicillin products are stocked under different brand names. Allergy histories are frequently recorded against a brand the patient remembers rather than against the active ingredient, so a brand-to-brand check will miss a real allergy.

2. EQUIVALENCE

Almodan has the same active ingredient as Amoxil. Both are amoxicillin preparations and differ only in presentation and manufacturer.

Amoxil has the same active ingredient as Amix. Any allergy recorded against one of these brands must be treated as applying to all of them.

3. ACTION

Prescribers must check the active ingredient and not the brand. This note is issued because two incidents in the last year involved a brand-name mismatch of exactly this kind.

Ms Priya Raghunathan, Lead Antimicrobial Pharmacist